



DOES PRACTICE MAKE PERFECT?

An unknown ancient Roman author wrote, “Practice is the best of all instructors.” So, is it true that the more you practice something the better you become? Could we all be superstars in our chosen field if we put the effort in and practice as much as possible? If you decided to become an Olympic athlete, a musical genius, a prima ballerina, or a chess whiz, could you achieve your dream through practice alone? The expression “practice makes perfect” has been in use for centuries, but is there any reason to believe that it is true? Is doing something over and over again the only way to do it well?

TRAIN YOUR BRAIN

Scientists researching the way that our brains control our bodies have reported that repetition—practice—can help us perfect our moves. Performing a motor skill involves the premotor cortex area of the brain. The brain plans how we are going to move to achieve a goal, and then our limbs follow its instructions and move. If you move in the right way, your brain stores the instructions so that you can do it again correctly. Even if you mess up, it remembers that, too. Practice helps you train your muscles to perform a task in a certain way.